

Awards

bids are being entertained. Other firms who have raised their voice include the National Association of Manufacturers and US Chamber of Commerce.

Recently a letter was sent to the US President Barack Obama stating that the Indian government has been indulging in a persistently discriminating pattern of business to benefit its own domestic business community and costing American jobs. The letter was signed by CEO and President of SEIA, Rhone Resch, along with various other business leaders.

It is nothing new that USA-based clean energy manufacturing companies have been reporting concerns against India's trade policies. The US has even approached the World Trade Organisation this February complaining on the "forced localisation requirements" in solar modules and cells.

500 solar pumps planned for Gujarat

The PGVCL (Paschim Gujarat Vij Company Limited) has planned installation of 500 solar pumps in farms under a state government project. The total expenditure for this project is estimated to be around Rs 200 million and the first beneficiaries will be farmers in Saurashtra. This is the first phase of an extensive plan and, if things go as per plan, the experiment will be put to widespread use.

According to PGVCL officials, the main goal of the project is to seek a sustainable form of alternate energy generation procedure and save the non-renewable resource that we are currently dependent upon. Also, solar power is perhaps the best option available in the current scenario with plenty of potential in these parts of the country.

The officials also added that there are many pending applications from farmers requesting for electricity connection. While these are still awaiting approval, they could alternatively be considered to be a part of the experiment with the government willing to provide them with an alternate source of power.

The cost of a solar pump in India is Rs 400,000, but under the project taken up by PGVCL, farmers will have to pay

ASUS products win multiple Awards at Computex Taipei 2013

ASUS Taichi ultrabook was the most awarded product at Computex 2013. The awards include the Best Choice of the Year Award, Best Choice Golden Award and the Computex D&I Gold Award.

Hughes Communications India gets best VSAT operator Award

Hughes Communications India Limited (HCIL) has won 'Best VSAT Operator in India' Award at the Telecom Operator Awards 2013. The award recognises companies that demonstrate outstanding performance in delivering world-class results in service and support in the telecom sector.

just 20 per cent of the cost and the rest will be borne by the government. This amounts to Rs 80,000 for each subscriber.

Along with this solar pump project, PGVCL is also working upon a 6.30MW solar power plant installation project at Rajkot and another 3.30MW capacity plant at Bhavnagar. These surely would be great achievements for the state.

Plans to set up manufacturing unit for Aakash 4

According to media reports, the government of India is now planning to launch a new version of Aakash tablet, which would probably be called Aakash 4. As reported by Indian Express, the Department of Information Technology has sought permission of Department of Science & Technology for routing the Aakash tablet project through them.

As per the report, the Union HRD minister, Kapil Sibal, has written to the prime minister and recommended that a manufacturing unit be set up for the new version of the Aakash tablet considering the problems faced in first Aakash tablet manufactured by Datawind.

"The draft of the specifications has been prepared, formally it has to be placed before a committee... We are waiting for a suitable date to do that," Department of Electronics and IT Secretary J. Satyanarayana said. "We should not add so many features so that the cost will go beyond," he added.

Datawind has launched three versions of Aakash tablet for students, which are currently being sold in the market under the brand name of UbiSlate (UbiSlate 7Ci, UbiSlate7C+ etc).

However, these tablets were criticised by the experts as well as users for their poor quality. The company faced a few more issues pertaining to non-supply by Datawind. It is worth mentioning here that several Indian and Chinese brands have also introduced tablets in the market within the same price range, but offering better quality and specifications as compared to the Aakash tablet introduced by Datawind.

MNRE to launch mega solar projects in India

The country has long been facing the problem of power cuts and rising electricity bills. In an announcement today, the Ministry of New and Renewable Energy said that it is planning on a big sized project that would boost the efforts to a greater extent.

The proposed projects are the size of 500 MW and above. Tarun Kapoor, the joint secretary for MNRE said that this project is aimed at bringing up the volume of renewable energy in the country. While several states are already working on their own mega project, it is time that the capital also gets its due.

Till now, the MNRE had been tendering projects the size of 50 MW or less via the guidelines of the Jawaharlal Nehru National Solar Mission, but this would be a first from its pocket. In other states like Kerala, Tamil Nadu, Gujarat and Karnataka, mega projects are either being commissioned or executed through already existing solar power projects in order to meet the rising demand for electricity and balance the escalating cost of power.

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